

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q  
 ♥ 4 3 2  
 ♦ A 10 7 5 3 2  
 ♣ J 9 2

♠ A J 8 7 6 3

♥ A Q 7

♦ K Q

♣ 8 7



♠ 10  
 ♥ J 10 9 8 5  
 ♦ 9 8 6  
 ♣ A 10 6 4

♠ K 9 5 4 2

♥ K 6

♦ J 4

♣ K Q 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ J

When partner opens 1 ♠ you have a pretty normal Jacoby 2NT response. He next says 3 ♠.

Your partner has a better than minimum hand with 6 ♠s. However, you have an average hand with no controls to show so you use the Principle of Fast Arrival and bid 4 ♠. Everyone passes.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 3  
 ♥ K J 9 5  
 ♦ K Q J 3  
 ♣ 9 7

♠ 9 6 2

♥ 7 2

♦ A 10 5 4

♣ J 10 5 3



♠ Q 7 4

♥ A Q 10 8 3

♦ 8 7

♣ K Q 6

♠ J 10 8 5

♥ 6 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A 8 4 2

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

4♥

Pass

4♠

Pass

5♥

All Pass

5♥ by East

Lead: ♠J

Partner's bid is game forcing. With a bare minimum, no singletons, you go ahead and sign off in game. Partner then says 4♠.

Partner is definitely showing slam interest. If you had a first round control in either Minor suit you would bid it now. But you don't. So you sign off again, this time at 5♥. Partner finally gives up on the idea of slam and passes.

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10

♥ A K J 10 7 2

♦ 6 4

♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ K Q J 4 2

♥ —

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ K Q 8 4



♠ 6

♥ Q 8 6 4 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ J 10 3 2

♠ A 9 8 7 5 3

♥ 9 5

♦ K Q J 10

♣ A

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

4♥

Pass

5♣

Pass

5♥

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by South

Lead: ♥K

You want to force partner to game while you describe your hand. So you make a Splinter Bid of 4♥. Partner replies 5♣.

Partner has the ♣A. Good. You are pretty worried about ♦s and also your 11 high card points. You are tempted to just sign off at 5♠ but you shouldn't. You can make a control-bid below the 5♠ level. So you bid 5♥. This tells partner that your Splinter must have been a ♥ void. Partner bids 6♠.

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 10 8 7

♥ A Q

♦ J 4

♣ A 10 8 3

♠ 2

♥ K 9 4 3

♦ 9 7 5 3 2

♣ 9 6 5



♠ K Q 6 4 3

♥ 7 6

♦ A K Q

♣ K Q J

♠ 9 5

♥ J 10 8 5 2

♦ 10 8 6

♣ 7 4 2

*West*

1 ♠

3NT

4 ♥

5 ♠

All Pass

7 ♠ by West

Lead: ♦ 2

*North*

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

*East*

2NT

4 ♦

4NT

7 ♠

*South*

Pass

Pass

Pass

With 17 points you need to indicate a better than minimum opening. You have no singletons and just a 5-card trump suit so you bid 3NT. Partner says 4 ♦ and it is your bid again.

Partner's 4 ♦ bid shows first round control (surely the Ace). You bid 4 ♥, showing your first round control. Partner now says 4NT.

You are being Blackwooded, and with three Aces you reply 5 ♠. That was apparently just what East wanted to hear, so he bid 7 ♠.

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 5 2  
 ♥ 7 4  
 ♦ 10 9 8 2  
 ♣ A 7 6 3

♠ 7 4 3

♥ A 10 8 5 2

♦ K J

♣ K Q 9



♠ A K Q 10 8

♥ 9 6

♦ 5 3

♣ J 8 5 4

♠ 9 6

♥ K Q J 3

♦ A Q 7 6 4

♣ 10 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

1 ♠

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ K

You were all set to give a Jacoby 2NT response when East stuck in his 1 ♠ overcall. Now you can't because Jacoby is off after opponents interfere. Fortunately you have another bid at your disposal. You say 2 ♠, showing good ♥s and a limit raise or better. Partner bids 3 ♥.

Partner didn't have enough to bid game, not knowing if you had more than 11 points. But you know you have opening hand so you bid 4 ♥.